

Stephen Vaisey

Duke University
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1364 Campus Drive (Box 90432)
Durham, NC 27708-90432

Academic Positions

- 2018– Professor of Sociology and Political Science, Duke University
2016– Professor of Sociology, Duke University
2012–2016 Associate Professor of Sociology, Duke University
2011–2012 Assistant Professor of Sociology, UC Berkeley and Duke University
2008–2011 Assistant Professor of Sociology, University of California, Berkeley

Academic Publications

- Womick, Jake, Emily Kubin, Daniela Goya-Tocchetto, Nicolas Restrepo Ochoa, Carlos Rebollar, Kyra Kapsaskis, Samuel Pratt, Helen Devine, B. Keith Payne, Stephen Vaisey, and Kurt Gray. 2026. "Liberals and Conservatives See Different Victims: Moral Disagreement Is Explained by Different Assumptions of Vulnerability." *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. doi:[10.1177/01461672261422957](https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672261422957).
- Combs, Aidan, Gabriel Varela, Dawn T. Robinson, Lynn Smith-Lovin, and Stephen Vaisey. 2025. "Deviations from Cultural Consensus about Occupations: The Duality of Occupation Meanings and Americans' Meaning Communities." *Social Networks* 82:153–65. doi:[10.1016/j.socnet.2025.04.003](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socnet.2025.04.003).
- Keskintürk, Turgut, Kevin Kiley, and Stephen Vaisey. 2025. "What Are You Talking about? Discussion Frequency of Issues Captured in Common Survey Questions." *Sociological Science* 12:256–76. doi:[10.15195/v12.a12](https://doi.org/10.15195/v12.a12).
- Keskintürk, Turgut, Pablo Bello, and Stephen Vaisey. 2025. "The Promises and Pitfalls of Using Panel Data to Understand Individual Belief Change." *Political Psychology*. doi:[10.1111/pops.70056](https://doi.org/10.1111/pops.70056).
- Ochoa, Nicolas Restrepo, and Stephen Vaisey. 2024. "Opinions on Hard-to-Discuss Topics Change More via Cohort Replacement." *Evolutionary Human Sciences* 6:e25. doi:[10.1017/ehs.2024.13](https://doi.org/10.1017/ehs.2024.13).
- Edelmann, Achim, and Stephen Vaisey. 2023. "Gender Differential Effect of College on Political Orientation over the Last 40 Years in the U.S.—a Propensity Score Weighting Approach." *PLOS ONE* 18(1):e0279273. doi:[10.1371/journal.pone.0279273](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0279273).
- Underwood, Ted, Kevin Kiley, Wenyi Shang, and Stephen Vaisey. 2022. "Cohort Succession Explains Most Change in Literary Culture." *Sociological Science* 9:184–205. doi:[10.15195/v9.a8](https://doi.org/10.15195/v9.a8).
- Valentino, Lauren, and Stephen Vaisey. 2022. "Culture and Durable Inequality." *Annual Review of Sociology* 48(1):109–29. doi:[10.1146/annurev-soc-030320-102739](https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-soc-030320-102739).
- Vaisey, Stephen, and Kevin Kiley. 2021. "A Model-Based Method for Detecting Persistent Cultural Change Using Panel Data." *Sociological Science* 8:83–95. doi:[10.15195/v8.a5](https://doi.org/10.15195/v8.a5).
- Vaisey, Stephen. 2021. "Welcome to the Real World: Escaping the Sociology of Culture and Cognition." *Sociological Forum* 36(S1):1297–1315. doi:[10.1111/socf.12770](https://doi.org/10.1111/socf.12770).
- Kiley, Kevin, and Stephen Vaisey. 2020. "Measuring Stability and Change in Personal Culture Using Panel Data." *American Sociological Review* 85(3):477–506. doi:[10.1177/0003122420921538](https://doi.org/10.1177/0003122420921538).

- Vaisey, Stephen, and Margaret Frye. 2019. "The Old One-Two: Preserving Analytical Dualism in Cognitive Sociology." Pp. 101–14 in *Oxford handbook of cognitive sociology*, edited by W. Brekhus and G. Ignatow. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Vaisey, Stephen, and Lauren Valentino. 2018. "Culture and Choice: Toward Integrating Cultural Sociology with the Judgment and Decision-Making Sciences." *Poetics* 68:131–43. doi:[10.1016/j.poetic.2018.03.002](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.poetic.2018.03.002).
- Boutyline, Andrei, and Stephen Vaisey. 2017. "Belief Network Analysis: A Relational Approach to Understanding the Structure of Attitudes." *American Journal of Sociology* 122(5):1371–1447. doi:[10.1086/691274](https://doi.org/10.1086/691274).
- Vaisey, Stephen, and Andrew Miles. 2017. "What You Can-and Can't-Do with Three-Wave Panel Data." *Sociological Methods & Research* 46(1):44–67. doi:[10.1177/0049124114547769](https://doi.org/10.1177/0049124114547769).
- Dehghani, Morteza, Kate Johnson, Joe Hoover, Eyal Sagi, Justin Garten, Niki Jitendra Parmar, Stephen Vaisey, Rumen Iliev, and Jesse Graham. 2016. "Purity Homophily in Social Networks." *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General* 145(3):366–75. doi:[10.1037/xge0000139](https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0000139).
- Vaisey, Stephen, and Omar Lizardo. 2016. "Cultural Fragmentation or Acquired Dispositions? A New Approach to Accounting for Patterns of Cultural Change." *Socius: Sociological Research for a Dynamic World* 2:2378023116669726. doi:[10.1177/2378023116669726](https://doi.org/10.1177/2378023116669726).
- Miles, Andrew, and Stephen Vaisey. 2015. "Morality and Politics: Comparing Alternate Theories." *Social Science Research* 53:252–69. doi:[10.1016/j.ssresearch.2015.06.002](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssresearch.2015.06.002).
- Victor, Elizabeth Christine, Andrew Miles, and Stephen Vaisey. 2014. "The Role of Moral Worldviews in Predicting Sexual Behavior from Adolescence to Emerging Adulthood." *Journal of Adolescent Research* 0743558414561294. doi:[10.1177/0743558414561294](https://doi.org/10.1177/0743558414561294).
- Edelmann, Achim, and Stephen Vaisey. 2014. "Cultural Resources and Cultural Distinction in Networks." *Poetics* 46:22–37. doi:[10.1016/j.poetic.2014.08.001](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.poetic.2014.08.001).
- Vaisey, Stephen. 2014a. "QCA Works—When Used with Care." *Sociological Methodology* 44(1):108–12. doi:[10.1177/0081175014542083](https://doi.org/10.1177/0081175014542083).
- Vaisey, Stephen, and Andrew Miles. 2014. "Tools from Moral Psychology for Measuring Personal Moral Culture." *Theory and Society* 43(3-4):311–32. doi:[10.1007/s11186-014-9221-8](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11186-014-9221-8).
- Vaisey, Stephen. 2014b. "The 'Attitudinal Fallacy' Is a Fallacy: Why We Need Many Methods to Study Culture." *Sociological Methods & Research* 43(2):227–31. doi:[10.1177/0049124114523395](https://doi.org/10.1177/0049124114523395).
- Vaisey, Stephen. 2014c. "Is Interviewing Compatible with the Dual-Process Model of Culture?" *American Journal of Cultural Sociology* 2(1):150–58. doi:[10.1057/ajcs.2013.8](https://doi.org/10.1057/ajcs.2013.8).
- Johnson, Kate M., Ravi Iyer, Sean P. Wojcik, Stephen Vaisey, Andrew Miles, Veronica Chu, and Jesse Graham. 2014. "Ideology-Specific Patterns of Moral Indifference Predict Intentions Not to Vote." *Analyses of Social Issues and Public Policy* 12(1):61–77. doi:[10.1111/asap.12039](https://doi.org/10.1111/asap.12039).
- Beyerlein, Kraig, and Stephen Vaisey. 2013. "Individualism Revisited: Moral Worldviews and Civic Engagement." *Poetics* 41(4):384–406. doi:[10.1016/j.poetic.2013.05.002](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.poetic.2013.05.002).
- Hitlin, Steven, and Stephen Vaisey. 2013. "The New Sociology of Morality." *Annual Review of Sociology* 39:51–68. doi:[10.1146/annurev-soc-071312-145628](https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-soc-071312-145628).
- Longest, Kyle C., Steven Hitlin, and Stephen Vaisey. 2013. "Position and Disposition: The Contextual Development of Human Values." *Social Forces* 91(4):1499–1528. doi:[10.1093/sf/sot045](https://doi.org/10.1093/sf/sot045).
- Vaisey, Stephen. 2012a. "Review of *Why Things Matter to People: Social Science, Values and Ethical Life*, by Andrew Sayer." *Contemporary Sociology: A Journal of Reviews* 41(5):671–72.

doi:[10.1177/0094306112457769jj](https://doi.org/10.1177/0094306112457769jj).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2012b. "Review of *the Righteous Mind: Why Good People Are Divided by Politics and Religion*, by Jonathan Haidt." *European Journal of Sociology / Archives Européennes de Sociologie* 53(03):448–51. doi:[10.1017/S0003975612000422](https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003975612000422).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2011. "Review of *the Theory of Cultural and Social Selection*, by W.G. Runciman." *American Journal of Sociology* 116(4):1377–80. doi:[10.1086/658102](https://doi.org/10.1086/658102).

Vaisey, Stephen, and Omar Lizardo. 2010. "Can Cultural Worldviews Influence Network Composition?" *Social Forces* 88(4):1595–1618.

Hitlin, Steven, and Stephen Vaisey, eds. 2010. *Handbook of the Sociology of Morality*. New York: Springer.

Vaisey, Stephen. 2010. "What People Want: Poverty, Aspirations, and Educational Attainment." *Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Sciences* 629:75–101. doi:[10.1177/0002716209357146](https://doi.org/10.1177/0002716209357146).

Adkins, Daniel E., and Stephen Vaisey. 2009. "Toward a Unified Stratification Theory: Structure, Genome, and Status Across Human Societies." *Sociological Theory* 27(2):99–121. doi:[10.1111/j.1467-9558.2009.01339.x](https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-9558.2009.01339.x).

Trinitapoli, Jenny, and Stephen Vaisey. 2009. "The Transformative Role of Religious Experience: The Case of Short-Term Missions." *Social Forces* 88(1):121–46. doi:[10.1353/sof.0.0223](https://doi.org/10.1353/sof.0.0223).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2009a. "Motivation and Justification: A Dual-Process Model of Culture in Action." *American Journal of Sociology* 114(6):1675–715.

Vaisey, Stephen. 2009b. "QCA 3.0: The 'Ragin Revolution' Continues." *Contemporary Sociology* 38(4):308–12.

Vaisey, Stephen. 2009c. "Review of *Fuzzy Set Theory: Applications in the Social Sciences*, by Michael Smithson and Jay Verkuilen." *Sociological Methods & Research* 37(3):455–57. doi:[10.1177/0049124107306675](https://doi.org/10.1177/0049124107306675).

Perrin, Andrew J., and Stephen Vaisey. 2008. "Parallel Public Spheres: Distance and Discourse in Letters to the Editor." *American Journal of Sociology* 114(3):781–810. doi:[10.1086/590647](https://doi.org/10.1086/590647).

Vaisey, Stephen, and Christian Smith. 2008. "Catholic Guilt Among U.S. Teenagers: A Research Note." *Review of Religious Research* 49(4):415–26. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/20447515>.

Shanahan, Michael J., Stephen Vaisey, Lance D. Erickson, and Andrew Smolen. 2008. "Environmental Contingencies and Genetic Propensities: Social Capital, Educational Continuation, and Dopamine Receptor Gene "DRD2"." *The American Journal of Sociology* 114:S260–86. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/25487984>.

Longest, Kyle C., and Stephen Vaisey. 2008a. "Control or Conviction: Religion and Adolescent Initiation of Marijuana Use." *Journal of Drug Issues* 38(3):689–715.

Longest, Kyle C., and Stephen Vaisey. 2008b. "Fuzzy: A Program for Performing Qualitative Comparative Analyses (QCA) in Stata." *The Stata Journal* 8(1):79–104. doi:[10.1177/1536867X0800800106](https://doi.org/10.1177/1536867X0800800106).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2008a. "Reply to Ann Swidler." *Sociological Forum* 23(3):619–22. doi:[10.1111/j.1573-7861.2008.00081.x](https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1573-7861.2008.00081.x).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2008b. "Socrates, Skinner, and Aristotle: Three Ways of Thinking about Culture in Action." *Sociological Forum* 23(3):603–13. <http://dx.doi.org/10.1111/j.1573-7861.2008.00079.x>.

Vaisey, Stephen. 2007a. "Structure, Culture, and Community: The Search for Belonging in 50 Urban Communes." *American Sociological Review* 72(6):851–73. doi:[10.1177/000312240707200601](https://doi.org/10.1177/000312240707200601).

Shanahan, Michael J., Lance D. Erickson, Stephen Vaisey, and Andrew Smolen. 2007. "Helping

Relationships and Genetic Propensities: A Combinatoric Study of DRD2, Mentoring, and Educational Continuation." *Twin Research and Human Genetics* 10(2):285–98. doi:[10.1375/twin.10.2.285](https://doi.org/10.1375/twin.10.2.285).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2007b. "Review of *Emerging Moral Vocabularies: The Creation and Establishment of New Forms of Moral and Ethical Meanings*, by Brian M. Lowe." *Contemporary Sociology* 36(3):259–60. doi:[10.1177/009430610703600332](https://doi.org/10.1177/009430610703600332).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2006. "Education and Its Discontents: Overqualification in America, 1972–2002." *Social Forces* 85(2):835–64. doi:[10.1353/sof.2007.0028](https://doi.org/10.1353/sof.2007.0028).

Kalleberg, Arne L., and Stephen Vaisey. 2005. "Pathways to a Good Job: Perceived Work Quality Among the Machinists in North America." *British Journal of Industrial Relations* 43(3):431–54. doi:[10.1111/j.1467-8543.2005.00363.x](https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-8543.2005.00363.x).

Vaisey, Stephen. 2004. "Review of *Human Institutions: A Theory of Societal Evolution*, by Jonathan H. Turner." *Social Forces* 83(1):432–33. doi:[10.1353/sof.2004.0129](https://doi.org/10.1353/sof.2004.0129).

Invited Presentations

2026 "Cohorts and Cultural Change." Office of Population Research, Princeton University.

2025 "Possible Futures for Cultural Evolution." Building a Science of Cultural Evolution for the 21st Century, Santa Fe Institute.

"Advancing Theory and Method for Understanding Cultural Change." Department of Sociology, University of Chicago; Department of Cognitive and Information Science, University of California–Merced.

2024 "Advancing Theory and Method for Understanding Cultural Change."

- Center for Wealth Inequality, Department of Sociology, Columbia University
- Department of Sociology, New York University
- Wisconsin Historical Analysis Table, Department of Sociology, University of Wisconsin–Madison

2023 "Cohort Effects and Cultural Change." Conference on Inertia in Biological and Cultural Systems, Institute for Advanced Study, Toulouse, France; Advanced Methods at Purdue, Purdue University.

2022 "Cohort Effects and Cultural Change." Evolution, Culture and Cognition Conference, Saint-Jacut-de-la-mer, France.

"How Common is Opinion Change?" Center for the Science of Moral Understanding, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.

"The Return of Socialization." Royal Netherlands Academy of Arts and Sciences, Amsterdam, Netherlands.

"True Interdisciplinarity." University of Nijmegen, Netherlands.

2021 "Measuring Stability and Change in Personal Culture." Department of Sociology, University of Texas, Austin; Department of Sociology, University of British Columbia.

"Methods for Detecting and Measuring Population-Level Cultural Evolution." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute.

"Shaping Intelligences: An Overview." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute (online).

2020 "Measuring Stability and Change in Personal Culture." Department of Sociology, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.

"Measuring Culture and Cultural Change." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute (online).

- "Shaping Intelligences." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute (online).
- 2019** "Methods for Detecting and Measuring Population-Level Cultural Evolution." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute, University of St. Andrews, UK.
- "Shaping Intelligences: An Overview." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute, University of St. Andrews, UK.
- 2018** "Theory and Time: How Past and Present Environments Influence Cultural Change." University of Cologne.
- "Culture and Cognition." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute, University of St. Andrews, UK.
- "Culture, Environment, and Change." Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute, University of St. Andrews, UK.
- "The Role of Time in Sociological Theory: An Empirical Investigation Using Repeated Cross-Section and Panel Data." Department of Sociology, University of Pennsylvania.
- 2017** "Measuring Morality: Progress, Challenges, and Prospects." Kenan Institute for Ethics, Duke University.
- 2016** Invited panelist, Causes and Consequences of Decision-Making in Urban Contexts conference. Radcliffe Institute, Harvard University.
- "Culture and Choice: Bridging the Gap Between Decision Theory and Cultural Sociology." Formalizing Culture conference, University of Bern, Switzerland.
- "Cultural Fragmentation or Acquired Dispositions? An Analytic Approach to Accounting for Patterns of Cultural Change." Department of Sociology, University of North Carolina.
- 2015** "Symbolic Boundaries Condition the Strength of Peer Influence: The Case of Religion and Alcohol Use." Duke Network Analysis Center, Duke University; Networks and Time Workshop, Columbia University.
- "Models of Culture and Social Change." Department of Sociology, Harvard University.
- "Cultural Sociology and Moral Psychology." Center for Mind, Brain, and Culture, Emory University; Values, Ideology, and Morality Lab, University of Southern California.
- "Deliberative and Unconscious Cognition." Measuring Culture Conference, University of Notre Dame.
- 2014** "Measuring Variance in Cultural Depth: Conceptual Clarification, a Method, and an Empirical Test." Center for Advanced Social Science Research, New York University.
- "The Sociology of Morality." Institute for Advanced Studies in Culture, University of Virginia.
- "Accounting for Variance in Cultural Depth." Center for Cultural Sociology, Yale University.
- 2013** "Cultural Durability and Social Change." Department of Sociology, Penn State University.
- 2012** "Tools for Measuring Moral Culture." Measuring Culture Conference, University of British Columbia, Vancouver.
- "Cultural Durability and Social Change."
- Department of Sociology, UNC-Charlotte
 - Department of Sociology, University of Virginia
 - Department of Sociology, UCLA
 - Department of Sociology, Umeå University (Sweden)
 - Economic Sociology Workshop, Harvard University and MIT Sloan School of Business

- 2011 "Cultural Depth and Social Change." Culture and Politics Workshop, UNC-Chapel Hill.
- 2010 "More Than a Feeling: How Culture Shapes Moral Intuitions and Social Behavior." Department of Sociology, Duke University.
- "What Is and What Ought to Be: Morals, Models, and Motives in the Study of Culture." Kenan Institute for Ethics, Duke University.
- "Inside Out: Changing Conceptions of the Actor-Environment Relationship in Social Science." Haas School of Business, University of California, Berkeley.
- "Reframing Norms: Linking Cultural Models and Moral Judgments in Social Research." Department of Sociology, Princeton University.
- 2009 "You *Can* Take It with You: The Trans-Situational Role of Culture in Action." Department of Sociology, Northwestern University; Department of Sociology, Duke University.
- "What People Want: Poverty, Aspirations, and Educational Attainment." Department of Sociology, University of California–San Diego.
- "Moral Cultures and Successful Societies." Meetings of the Successful Societies Program of the Canadian Institute for Advanced Research, San Francisco.
- 2008 "Imagination and Desire: Poor/Non-Poor Differences in Future Aspirations." Miniconference on Culture and Poverty (sponsored by the Ford Foundation), National Opinion Research Center, University of Chicago.
- 2007 "Motivation and Justification: Toward a Dual Process Theory of Culture in Action."
- Department of Sociology, Washington State University
 - Department of Sociology, University of Chicago
 - Department of Sociology, Indiana University
 - Department of Sociology, University of Michigan
 - Department of Sociology, UC Irvine
 - Department of Sociology, Cornell University
 - Department of Sociology, UC Berkeley
 - Graduate School of Business, Stanford University
 - Department of Sociology, University of Pennsylvania
 - Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University

Conference Presentations

- 2026 "Cohorts and Cultural Change." Paper presented at the Historical Psychology Pre-conference at the annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.
- 2025 "The Promises and Pitfalls of Using Panel Data to Understand Individual Belief Change." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the International Network of Analytical Sociology, Columbia University.
- "The Promises and Pitfalls of Using Panel Data to Understand Individual Belief Change." Paper presented at the Sociological Science annual conference, Cornell University.
- 2024 "The Promises and Pitfalls of Using Panel Data to Understand Individual Belief Change." Conference on Adult Belief Change, Nijmegen, Netherlands.
- 2023 "Cohorts and Cultural Change." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the International Network of Analytical Sociology, Princeton University.
- "How Common Is Opinion Change? Evidence from a 17-Wave Longitudinal Survey." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Eastern Sociological Society, Baltimore.

- 2021** "Sociology and Cultural Evolution: Obstacles and Future Directions." Paper presented at the meetings of the Cultural Evolution Society (online).
- 2018** "Is Cultural Sociology Compatible with the Judgment and Decision Sciences?" Paper presented at the Culture and Class Mini-Conference at the annual meeting of the Eastern Sociological Society, Baltimore.
- "Morality: Meaning and Measure." Invited panelist at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Philadelphia.
- 2017** "What is the Right Level of Psychological Realism for Cultural Sociology?" Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montréal, Canada.
- "Is Religion Really Just Culture? Is Culture Really Just Religion?" Panel participant at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Montréal, Canada.
- 2016** "Symbolic Boundaries and Peer Influence on Alcohol Use." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Seattle. (Co-authored with Achim Edelmann.)
- "Pronoun Use and Cultural Models of the Self." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Eastern Sociological Society. (Co-authored with Lauren Valentino.)
- 2015** "Belief Network Analysis of American Public Opinion: Findings from a Novel Structural Methodology." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Chicago. (Co-authored with Andrei Butyline.)
- 2014** "Affinities of Language, Cultural Tool Kits, Institutional Logics: Advancing Strategies of Action." Panelist at the annual meeting of the Academy of Management, Philadelphia.
- "Cultural Durability and Social Change." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Eastern Sociological Society, Baltimore.
- 2013** "Cultural Sociology and Moral Psychology." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, New York.
- "Value Similarity and Solidarity." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, New York. (Co-authored with Liana Prescott.)
- 2012** "The Structure of Belief Systems: Ideology and Network Centrality." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Denver. (Co-authored with Andrei Butyline.)
- 2011** "Cultural Models and Altruism." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Las Vegas.
- 2010** "From Contradiction to Coherence: Theory Building in the Sociology of Culture." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Atlanta.
- 2009** "Models, Morals, and Motives." Paper presented at the Junior Theorists Symposium, Berkeley, CA.
- 2008** "The Cultural Consequences of Modernity: Individualization, Rationalization, and Subjective Well-Being." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, Boston. (Co-authored with Andrew Payton.)
- 2007** "Can Cultural Worldviews Influence Network Formation? A Longitudinal Investigation." Paper presented at the annual meeting of the American Sociological Association, New York.

Grants and Awards

- 2026** Dean's Award for Excellence in Mentoring, The Graduate School, Duke University.

2023–25	Co-Principal Investigator (with Christopher Johnston and Jessi Streib). “Young Voices: How Kids Develop Political Identities.” Bass Connections, Duke University. \$24,596.
2023–24	Principal Investigator (with Christopher Johnston and Jessi Streib). “Youth Political Socialization.” Social Science Research Institute, Duke University. \$14,336.
2021	Clifford Geertz Best Paper Award (for “Measuring Stability and Change in Personal Culture”). Culture Section of the American Sociological Association.
2015–18	Co-Principal Investigator (with Jesse Graham and Morteza Dehghani). “The Spread and Impact of Moral Messages: Machine Learning, Network Evolution, and Behavioral Prediction.” National Science Foundation. \$640,267.
2014–17	Principal Investigator. “The Social Context and Consequences of Transformative Experience.” John Templeton Foundation. \$300,000.
2011–13	Principal Investigator. “Developing and Deploying Innovative Methods for Assessing Moral Worldviews and Moral Formation.” John Templeton Foundation. \$400,000.
2011	Theory Prize for Best Article (for “Motivation and Justification”). Theory Section of the American Sociological Association.
2009–12	“Stimulating Innovative Global Research in the Science of Generosity: RFP & Primary Research Initiative on Origins, Manifestations, and Consequences.” (Co-Investigator, with Christian Smith, PI). John Templeton Foundation. \$4,999,360.
2007–10	“Tracking the Religious Lives of American Youth into Early Adulthood: NSYR Wave 3.” (Co-Investigator, with Christian Smith, PI). Lilly Endowment Inc. \$1,096,631.
2007–08	Charlotte W. Newcombe Dissertation Fellowship (Woodrow Wilson National Fellowship Foundation).
2007–08	Howard W. Odum Award for Excellence (given yearly to most outstanding graduate student by the UNC Sociology faculty).
2006–08	Yale University Center for Cultural Sociology Pre-Doctoral Fellowship.
2003–06	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship.
2002–08	Caroline H. and Thomas S. Royster, Jr. Fellowship (Graduate School, UNC).

Graduate Student Advising

Duke	<i>Dissertation chair:</i> Andrew Miles (2015), Mary Beth Fallin Hunzaker (2017), Lauren Valentino (2019), Joshua Doyle (2020), Kevin Kiley (2021), Susan Jacobs (2022), Nicolas Restrepo Ochoa (2022), Pablo Bello (exp. 2027), Turgut Keskindurk (exp. 2027). <i>Dissertation committee:</i> Feng Tian (2014), Cyrus Schliefer (2015), Jacob Fisher (2016), Amie Bostic (2016), Jessica Dawson (2016), Raphaël Chénier (2017), Bryce Bartlett (2018), Brent Curdy (2018), Nick Bloom (2019), Simon Brauer (2019), Josh Bruce (2019), Friedolin Herfort (2019), Maria Cristina Ramos Flor (2020), Danielle Montagne (2023), Joseph Roso (2023), Tom Wolff (2023), Noah Gibson (2025), Andres Castro Araujo (exp. 2026), Isabella Bouklas (exp. 2026).
Berkeley	<i>Dissertation co-chair:</i> Hannah Emery (2013). <i>Dissertation committee:</i> Alexander Janus (2012). <i>MA chair:</i> Aaron Platt (2011). <i>MA committee:</i> Margaret Frye (2009), Dmitri Seals (2010), Andrei Boutyline (2011), Sun Kim (2012), Michael Schultz (2012).

Other *Dissertation committee:* Adam Long (University of North Carolina, 2014), Jaime Wright (Graduate Theological Union, 2016), Austin Kozlowski (University of Chicago, 2022), Bridget Ritz (University of Notre Dame, 2022), Jan Pfänder (Université PSL, 2025).

Teaching

Data Analysis and Visualization for Business (undergraduate) — Duke University
Classical Sociological Theory (graduate) — Duke University
Graduate Statistics (two-course sequence) — UC Berkeley and Duke University
Sociology of Culture (graduate) — UC Berkeley, Duke University
Introduction to Sociology (undergraduate) — UC Berkeley
Sociology of Culture (undergraduate) — UC Berkeley, Duke University
Social Theory (undergraduate) — UNC-Chapel Hill
Multilevel and Mixed Models Using R — Statistical Horizons
Multilevel and Mixed Models Using Stata — Statistical Horizons
Matching and Weighting for Causal Inference in R — Statistical Horizons
Treatment Effects Analysis in Stata — Statistical Horizons
Longitudinal Data Analysis Using R — Statistical Horizons
Longitudinal Data Analysis Using Stata — Statistical Horizons

Department and University Service

2025– Chair, Arts and Sciences Budget Advisory Committee, Duke University.
2025– Graduate Committee, Duke Sociology.
2024– Arts and Sciences Council Sociology Representative, Duke University.
2018– Founding Director, Worldview Lab, Kenan Institute for Ethics, Duke University.
2016–25 Arts and Sciences Courses Committee, Duke University.
2014–16, 18– Faculty Council, Kenan Institute for Ethics.
2013–19 Director of Graduate Studies, Duke Sociology.
2014–15 Arts and Sciences ad-hoc committee on plagiarism sanctions, Duke University.
2011–16 Markets and Management Steering Committee, Duke University.
2011–13 Graduate Admissions Committee, Duke Sociology.
2011–14 Founding Co-Director, Moral Judgment and Decision Lab, Duke University.
2009–10 Faculty Undergraduate Advisor, Berkeley Sociology.
2008–09, 10–11 Graduate Admissions Committee, Berkeley Sociology.

Professional Service

2026– Editor-in-Chief, *Sociological Science*.
2025 Member, External Review Committee, Stanford University.
2024 Organizer, inaugural *Sociological Science* conference, Duke University.

2023–	Member, General Social Survey Board.
2022–2026	Deputy Editor, <i>Sociological Science</i> .
2020–	Editorial Board, <i>Social Science Research</i> .
2019–21	Consigliere, Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute.
2018–19	Editorial Board, <i>Sociological Methodology</i> .
2015–	Editorial Board, <i>Poetics</i> .
2014–22	Consulting Editor, <i>Sociological Science</i> .
2014–15	Member, Geertz Prize Committee, ASA Section on Culture.
2012–15	Elected Council Member, ASA Theory Section.
2012–15	Elected Council Member, ASA Section on Altruism, Morality, and Solidarity.
2012–13	Chair, Geertz Prize Committee, ASA Section on Culture.
2011–	Editorial Board, <i>Social Forces</i> .
2011–12	Chair, Theory Prize Committee, ASA Theory Section.
2011–12	Outstanding Book Award Committee, ASA Altruism Section.
2010–13	Elected Council Member, ASA Section on Culture.
2010–13	Editorial Board, <i>Sociological Theory</i> .
2009–12	Consulting Editor, <i>American Journal of Sociology</i> .
2015–18	Editorial Board, <i>Socius</i> .
2008–19	Editorial Board, <i>Journal for the Scientific Study of Religion</i> .
2008–09	Best Student Paper Award Committee, ASA Section on Culture.

Member: Cultural Evolution Society, Sociological Research Association, Society for Sociological Science.

Ad Hoc Reviewer: Administrative Science Quarterly, American Journal of Cultural Sociology, American Journal of Sociology, American Sociological Review, British Journal of Sociology, Cognition, Complexity, Evolutionary Human Sciences, Journal for the Scientific Study of Religion, Journal for the Theory of Social Behavior, Journal of Health and Social Behavior, Nature Human Behavior, Organization Science, Personality and Social Psychology Review, PLoS ONE, Poetics, Political Science Research and Methods, Public Opinion Quarterly, Review of Religious Research, Social Forces, Social Psychological Quarterly, Sociological Forum, Sociological Methods and Research, Sociological Science, Sociological Theory, Theory and Society; Cambridge University Press, Harvard University Press, Oxford University Press, University of Chicago Press; John Templeton Foundation, National Science Foundation.

Education

2008	PhD in Sociology, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.
2004	MA in Sociology, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.
2001	BA in French and BS in Sociology, Brigham Young University.